Alfie Thomas Lancaster

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Location: Madrid, Spain (Registered with full working rights: NIE, NUSS, and Padrón)

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An MSc Computer Science graduate (Distinction) with a background in law (LLB), specialising in improving data workflows, reporting, and administrative processes. Experienced in looking at business and operational bottlenecks to see how they can be automated or improved using Power BI, Power Automate, and AI-assisted Python scripting. Combines technical implementation skills with four years of experience working within regulated local government finance environments. **Native English speaker with conversational Spanish.**

Experience

Finance Systems & Automation Officer - North Yorkshire Council, UK. (Oct 2024 - May 2026)

- **System Ownership:** Lead technical contributor for reporting and automation within the Court of Protection finance system.
- **Reporting & Data Modeling:** Developed and maintained internal reporting suites and data models using Power BI and DAX within the Benefits, Assessments & Charging service.
- **Process Automation:** Configured and deployed desktop automation (RPA) workflows using Power Automate Desktop to reduce high-volume manual data tasks.
- **Scripting Solutions:** Implemented AI-assisted Python scripts to optimize and speed up recurring administrative data tasks.
- **System Support:** Provided escalation support for finance software users and offered practical recommendations to improve team workflows and eliminate operational bottlenecks.

Digital Officer - North Yorkshire Council, UK. (Nov 2023 - Oct 2024)

- **IT Support & Systems:** Provided technical support across IT environments, including firewall configurations, network-attached storage (NAS) systems, and content filtering.
- **M365 Administration:** Managed user accounts, permissions, and basic configurations within Microsoft 365 (Exchange, Admin Center, Intune).
- **System Deployment:** Handled device rollouts, endpoint security tasks, and assisted with SharePoint site configurations.

Court of Protection & Appointee Officer - North Yorkshire Council, UK. (March 2023 - Nov 2023)

- **Financial Administration:** Managed financial case portfolios within a regulated Adult Social Care environment, handling billing, income, and asset records using Caspar and Oracle EBS.
- **Compliance Reporting:** Prepared financial reconciliations and statutory reports for the Office of the Public Guardian.
- **Collaboration:** Acted as a liaison between legal teams, social workers, and financial advisors to resolve cross-team queries.

Business Support Officer - Court of Protection (Paralegal Secondment) - North Yorkshire Council. (September 2022 - March 2023)

- **Legal Support & Casework:** Assisted with complex Court of Protection and Appointeeship casework within a regulated Adult Social Care environment. Prepared legal documentation, statutory court bundles, and regulatory reports in strict alignment with OPG requirements.
- **Financial Processing:** Managed day-to-day financial processing, including client account transactions, fee payments, and monthly account reconciliations.
- **Tool Creation:** Identified reporting inefficiencies and built custom, user-friendly Excel tools, including a team workload tracker and a dedicated OPG120 form calculator to reduce manual calculation errors and speed up processing times.
- **Information Management:** Maintained system housekeeping across case management databases, ensuring high levels of data accuracy and compliance during the secondment.

Finance Support Officer - North Yorkshire Council. (May 2022 - September 2022)

- **Financial Controls:** Managed payment processing, credit controls, and billing cycles across a diverse portfolio of external care providers. Raised client invoices and processed journals within Oracle EBS.
- **Data Verification:** Managed overpayment recovery initiatives and performed complex financial reconciliations between external provider records and internal ledgers.
- **Workflow Optimization:** Designed, structured, and maintained advanced Excel workbooks used by the team to track financial controls, helping to resolve cross-team discrepancies and system queries.
- **Process Review:** Actively reviewed daily workflows to pinpoint manual, repetitive steps, establishing a foundation for streamlining finance administration within the department.

Early Career Experience (2016–2022)

- Worked in various customer-facing and operational roles across hospitality, logistics, and retail environments while completing academic studies.

Education

MSc Computer Science, University of Wolverhampton (2024 - 2025)
Graduated with distinction.

LLB Law (Hons), Teesside University (2020 - 2023)
Graduated with grade 2.1

Diploma in Business Studies, Darlington College (2018 - 2020)

Level 5 TEFL Certificate (Teaching English as a Foreign Language)

🎓 **Google UX Design Professional Certificate**

Projects

BI Reporting Architecture Redesign (Power BI, DAX, SharePoint)

- Replaced a series of disconnected Excel sheets with a structured data layer using SharePoint Lists to store team data.
- Built a relational data model and used Power Query to clean and transform incoming data.
- Set up Power BI dashboards with DAX measures to track operational timelines, such as working-day durations and case lifecycles.

RPA Automation – 22,000 Record Uplift Process (Power Automate Desktop)

- Configured a desktop workflow using Power Automate's low-code interface to read records from an Excel spreadsheet and input them into an online portal.
- Built logic steps into the workflow to handle system errors and prevent duplicate entries.
- Successfully cleared a large backlog of approximately 22,000 records, saving the team massive manual data-entry time.

Document Generation Tool (AI-Assisted Python, pandas)

- Utilized AI tools to help generate and debug a Python script using the Pandas library to sort and group raw data exports.
- Implemented the script to automate the document preparation steps, reducing a repetitive 4-hour manual process down to a few minutes.

Technical & Core Skills

- **Data & Reporting:** Power BI, DAX, Power Query, Relational Data Modeling, Advanced Excel.
- **Automation:** Power Automate Desktop (RPA), AI-Assisted Python (Pandas library), Workflow Design.

- **Core Competencies:** Operational Bottleneck Analysis, Process Improvement, Requirements Gathering, Legal & Financial Compliance.
- **Systems & Design:** SharePoint Lists, Microsoft 365 Administration, Oracle EBS, Figma UI/UX (Basic).
- **Languages:** English (Native), Spanish (Good conversational level).